GIACOMO MELLI

giacomo.melli@sociology.ox.ac.uk · Personal Website · Google Scholar · ORCID

PROFILE

Sociologist working at the intersection of social stratification and comparative political sociology. Studies how class and social status shape political preferences and participation, and how inequalities in political engagement are reproduced across generations and over the life course. A further line of research uses personal network data to study status, social ties, and political behaviour.

Research interests: Social Stratification, Social Inequalities, Political Behaviour, Electoral Participation, Comparative Political Sociology, Life Course, Social Networks, Quantitative Methods

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (DPhil) in Sociology 2023 – 2026
University of Oxford (UK); awarded 14 September 2026
Thesis title: 'The Bond That Lasts? Class Mobility, Political Socialisation, and Electoral Participation in Britain.'
Supervisors: Geoffrey Evans, Nan Dirk de Graaf.
Examiners: Daniel Oesch (Lausanne), Stephen Fisher (Oxford)
Graduate courses: Core Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics, Machine Learning, Longitudinal Data Analysis

MSc in Sociology and Social Research, *summa cum laude* 2020 – 2023
University of Trento (IT)
Thesis title: 'Where I Stand and What I Stand For. Subjective Social Position and Political Attitudes in Europe.'
Supervisors: Stefani Scherer, Geoffrey Evans, Leo Azzollini
Junior Visiting Scholar, Nuffield College, University of Oxford, Autumn 2022 (Advisor: Geoffrey Evans)

BA in Political, Social, and International Science, *summa cum laude* 2017 – 2020
University of Bologna (IT)

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-reviewed journal articles

Melli, Giacomo, Leo Azzollini, & Franco Bonomi Bezzo (2026) Healthcare Provision and Attitudes Towards Redistribution. A Regional Analysis across Europe. *Journal of European Public Policy*, *33*(4), 1119–1147.

Dolci, Giorgio & **Melli, Giacomo** (2026) Measuring Populism in Europe. Comparison and Validation in the European Social Survey. *Quality & Quantity*, *60*, 837–855. (Authors contributed equally.)

Melli, Giacomo, Nan Dirk de Graaf, & Geoffrey Evans (2025) Social Mobility, Self Selection, and the Persistence of Class Inequality in Electoral Participation. *The British Journal of Sociology*, *76*(5), 1040–1051.

Melli, Giacomo & Leo Azzollini (2025) Where I Stand and What I Stand For: Subjective Status, Class, and Redistribution. *Social Science Research*, *130*, 103210. (Featured in *The Conversation*.)

Melli, Giacomo (2025) Class, Subjective Status, and Turnout in Europe. *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*, *97*, 101039.

Melli, Giacomo (2025) Intergenerational Social Class Mobility and Support for Redistributive Policies in Italy, 2003–2024. *Stato & Mercato*, *45*(3), 303–344. Preprint available here.

Melli, Giacomo & Leo Azzollini (2025) Uncovering Misperceptions of Social Inequalities: What Matters Most, Objective Class or Subjective Social Status? *Frontiers in Sociology*, 10:1617413.

Melli, Giacomo & Stefani Scherer (2024) Populist Attitudes, Subjective Social Status, and Resentment in Italy. *Social Indicators Research*, *173*(3), 589–606.

Book chapters

- **Melli, Giacomo** & Stefani Scherer (2026). Identità di classe e attitudini verso le disuguaglianze e la redistribuzione [Class Identity and Attitudes towards Inequality and Redistribution]. In C. Ranci, A. Parma, & M. Matsaganis (eds.) *Insicurezza economica. Anatomia del caso italiano*. Bologna: il Mulino.
- van Ditmars, Mathilde M., Macarena Ares, & **Giacomo Melli**. Social Class and Voting. In P. Vasilopoulos, A. Sanders, & R. Dassonneville (eds.) *Voting Behaviour*. Oxford University Press, under contract, expected 2027.

Under review

- **Melli, Giacomo**. *How Parties Reshaped Class Participation: The Central Role of Parental Abstention*
- **Melli, Giacomo**. *Given and Chosen Ties: Social Status, Personal Networks, and Political Behaviour*

Preprints

- **Melli, Giacomo**. *The Reproduction of Political Inequality: Parents Account for Class Differences in Turnout*
- Azzollini, Leo, **Giacomo Melli**, & Stefani Scherer. *Same Job, Different Status? The Social Significance of Network Status Deviation Across 28 Societies*

Working papers

- **Melli, Giacomo**. *Political Inequality in Democratic Engagement. Can Public Spending on Education Close the Gap?*
- **Melli, Giacomo**. *Who Misreports Social Origins? Measurement Bias in Retrospective Class and Education Data*
- **Melli, Giacomo**, Leo Azzollini, Stefani Scherer, & Geoffrey Evans. *Broken Promises: Structural Change and Political Disaffection across British Generations*
- **Melli, Giacomo**, Mathilde M. van Ditmars, & Geoffrey Evans. *The Political Relevance of Subjective Class in Europe (1987–2019)*
- **Melli, Giacomo** & Fabian Kratz. *The Rising Importance of Social Origin: A Comparative Analysis of Political Dissatisfaction*
- van Ditmars, Mathilde M. & **Giacomo Melli**. *The Intergenerational Continuity of the Educational Divide in Young Europeans' Political Attitudes and EU Support*
- Azzollini, Leo, **Giacomo Melli**, & Clara Weißenfels. *Life Course Resource Trajectory Model for Political Engagement*
- **Melli, Giacomo**, Franco Bonomi Bezzo, & Anne-Marie Jeannet. *The Value of Work across Generations and Gender: How Grandparents Matter in Post-Industrial Societies*
- **Melli, Giacomo** & Enrico Benassi. *Housing Trajectories and the Lasting Echo of Social Origin on Political Engagement*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor in Foundations of Social Network Analysis (graduate level) Feb 2027
Methods School, Winter Programme, European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) *Online*
Sole instructor for doctoral students, postdoctoral researchers, and faculty; 15 hours of teaching in R, up to four ECTS.

Tutor in Political Sociology (undergraduate level) 2024 – 2026
Department of Sociology, University of Oxford *Oxford, UK*
Tutorials for the BA in PPE, about 30 students in total; weekly essays and written examinations marked, with feedback.

Tutor in Sociological Theory (undergraduate level) 2025
Department of Sociology, University of Oxford *Oxford, UK*
Small-group tutorial teaching for the Sociological Theory paper of the BA in PPE, to 5 students. Weekly essays marked, with written and oral feedback.

Teaching Assistant in Quantitative Methods (undergraduate level) Oct 2021 – Mar 2022
Department of Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento *Trento, IT*
Teaching assistant on two BA courses in quantitative methods; individual and small-group revision sessions.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant Apr 2023 – Sep 2023
Department of Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento *Trento, IT*
PRIN project 'RISing – RISing Inequality and Social Insecurity of the middle class: measures, drivers, policies'; Advisor: Stefani Scherer.

Research Intern Sep 2021 – Oct 2021
Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan *Milan, IT*
ERC project 'DESPO – Deindustrializing Societies and the Political Consequences'; Advisor: Anne-Marie Jeannet.

FUNDING AND AWARDS

Sir Roger Fry Scholarship Oct 2023 – Sep 2026
Awarded by Trinity College (Oxford) in conjunction with the Department of Sociology of the University of Oxford.

Graduate Scholarship 2025
Awarded by the Governing Body of Trinity College (Oxford) for outstanding academic achievements.

RC28 Aage B. Sørensen Travel Award 2025
Awarded by the Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility of the ISA, in recognition of good scholarship in the field of stratification, to attend the 2025 Spring Meeting in Milan.

Department of Sociology Graduate Research Support Funding 2024, 2025
Awarded by the Department of Sociology (Oxford) to support conference attendance and training courses.

Graduate Prize 2024
Awarded by the Governing Body of Trinity College (Oxford) for excellent academic achievements.

INVITED TALKS

Department of Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento 2025
Brown Bag Seminar Series of the Center for Social Inequality Studies
'Political Socialisation and Electoral Participation over the Life Course. Class, Family, and the Reproduction of Inequality.'

Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan 2025
Parties, Voters, and Elections Seminar Series
'Class, Family, and Turnout. The Intergenerational Transmission of Electoral Participation over the Life Course.'

European Studies Centre, St Antony's College, University of Oxford 2024
Left-behind Places across Europe: Emergence, Characteristics, Perspectives

CONFERENCES

- Analytical Sociology: Theory and Empirical Applications, LMU Munich, Venice International University, and the Academy of Sociology, San Servolo, Venice 2026
- Convegno della Società Italiana di Scienza Politica (SISP), Trento 2026
- Politics & Society Workshop Series, Queen Mary University of London 2026
- In_Equality Conference, Konstanz 2026
- SISEC, Italian Society of Economic Sociology 2023, 2025, 2026
- ECSR – European Consortium for Sociological Research, Cologne 2025
- ESPAnet, Milan 2025

- RC28 – ISA Research Committee on Social Stratification and Mobility, Milan 2025
- World Values Survey Conference, King's College London 2024
- Inaugural British Journal of Sociology Conference, LSE 2024
- International Conference on Political Sociology (AIS), University of Bologna 2024
- Elections, Public Opinion and Parties (EPOP), Manchester 2024
- Politics & Society Workshop Series, University of Oslo 2024

ACADEMIC SERVICE AND ORGANISATION

Seminar series

- Co-convenor, 'Trajectories: A Seminar Series on Inequality, the Life Course, and Politics', monthly online series, with Clara Weißenfels (Siegen) 2026 –

Conference and session organisation

- Stream organiser, 'Economic Sociology and Democracy', SISEC, Florence (2 sessions, 10 papers), with Leo Azzollini 2026
- Stream organiser, 'Life Course and the Politics of Social Policy', ESPAnet, Milan (2 sessions, 10 papers), with Anne-Marie Jeannet and Leo Azzollini 2025
- Session chair, ECSR (Cologne) and RC28 Spring Meeting (Milan) 2025

Peer review

Reviewer for *British Journal of Sociology*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *Acta Politica*, *Research in Social Stratification and Mobility*, *European Societies*, *Advances in Life Course Research*, *International Journal of Comparative Sociology*, *International Journal of Public Opinion Research*, *International Sociology*, *Quality & Quantity*, *Socius*.

Representation

Postgraduate Representative, Department of Sociology, University of Oxford Nov 2023 – Oct 2024

METHODS TRAINING

- **Mitchell Autumn School in Social Network Analysis** Oct – Dec 2026
  Mitchell Centre for Social Network Analysis, University of Manchester. Network theory, research design and data collection, whole-network and ego-network analysis, visualisation, community detection, equivalence, two-mode networks, hypothesis testing.
- **Python for Social Science Researchers** 2026
  Social Sciences Division, University of Oxford. Python for social research; data cleaning and management; functions and loops; visualisation and regression. 8 hours.
- **Core Econometrics** 2025
  Department of Economics, University of Oxford. Audited (MPhil in Economics core course). Instructor: Bent Nielsen. Probability and statistical inference; linear regression; instrumental variables; GMM; maximum likelihood; limited dependent variables; time series; panel data; causal inference. 8 weeks.
- **Advanced Econometrics** 2025
  Department of Economics, University of Oxford. Audited (MPhil in Economics core course). Instructor: Bent Nielsen. Asymptotic theory; model selection and machine learning; non-parametric and semi-parametric methods; simulation methods; advanced topics in time series, panel data, and causal inference. 8 weeks.
- **TN Square – Trento School of Applied Quantitative Methods**: Social Policies 2024
  Department of Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento. Instructors: Gerda Neyer, Sunnee Billingsley, Emmanuele Pavolini, Leo Azzollini, Bernd Fitzenberger, Arnim Seidlitz. Social investment; discrete-time event history analysis; multilevel regression; evaluation of policy reforms; semi-parametric event studies and quasi-experimental methods. 3 days.
- **Machine Learning** 2024
  Oxford Internet Institute, University of Oxford. Audited (MSc in Social Data Science core course). Instructor:

Chris Russell. Supervised and unsupervised learning; regularisation; support vector machines and tree-based methods; neural networks and deep learning; language models. 8 weeks.

- **Machine Learning for Social Science** 2024
  RECSM Summer Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona. Instructor: Christoph Kern. Decision trees, random forests, boosting, regularised regression; model evaluation and tuning; in R. 3 days.
- **Advanced R for Social Science Researchers** 2023
  Social Sciences Division, University of Oxford. Loops, conditionals, and functions; reproducible workflows; longitudinal data management; pipes. 8 hours.
- **Data Visualization in Demographic Studies** 2023
  Hans Schadee Research Methods Center, University of Trento. Instructor: Juan Galeano. Communicating results through visualisation in demographic and social research. 2 days.
- **Comparative Social Research with Multi-Group Structural Equation Modelling** 2023
  GESIS Spring Seminar, Cologne. Instructors: Daniel Seddig, Eldad Davidov, Peter Schmidt, Yannick Diehl. Measurement equivalence with MGCFA in lavaan; partial equivalence; comparison of latent means and coefficients across groups; alignment and Bayesian SEM. 30 hours.
- **Advanced Social Networks** (6 ECTS) 2022
  MSc in Sociology and Social Research, University of Trento. Instructor: Filip Agneessens. Centrality, cohesion, structural holes, two-mode networks, equivalence, statistical tests, and exponential random graph models, in R.
- **Modern Causal Analysis: Causal Inference Based on Non-Experimental Data** 2022
  Hans Schadee Research Methods Center, University of Trento. Instructor: Michael Gebel. Counterfactual model; DAGs; regression from a causal perspective; propensity score matching; instrumental variables; difference-in-differences; in Stata. 2 days.
- **Correspondence Analysis** 2022
  Hans Schadee Research Methods Center, University of Trento. Instructor: Joerg Blasius. Simple and multiple correspondence analysis; supplementary variables; social spaces. 3 days.

SKILLS

Languages: Italian (native), English (C2, full professional proficiency), Spanish (C1)
Software: Stata (advanced), R (panel and network analysis), LaTeX, UCINET, Python (working knowledge)

REFERENCES

Geoffrey Evans
Nuffield College
University of Oxford
New Road, Oxford
OX1 1NF, UK
geoffrey.evans@
nuffield.ox.ac.uk

Nan Dirk de Graaf
Nuffield College
University of Oxford
New Road, Oxford
OX1 1NF, UK
nan.degraaf@
nuffield.ox.ac.uk

Stefani Scherer
Department of Sociology
University of Trento
Via Verdi 26, 38122
Trento, Italy
stefani.scherer@
unitn.it

Delia Baldassarri
Department of Sociology
New York University
79 Washington Square East
New York, NY 10003
db1794@nyu.edu